

Tobias Treppmann

Design systems shaped by how the organization actually works

CONTACT

LOCATION

Berlin, Germany

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PORTFOLIO

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LINKEDIN

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EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA
Completed 2026

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

SKILLS

Design systems

DTCG design tokens · Style Dictionary · Storybook · Figma variables and live library sync · multi-platform token pipelines · component APIs and specifications · design systems built to stay intact under AI-assisted work · governance and contribution paths

Accessibility

EU Accessibility Act audits · WCAG contrast checked in code · screen-reader semantics and ARIA · AI-generated alt text in production across six countries

Building and tools

Prototyping in real code against production APIs · Android and Kotlin · SwiftUI · React and web · Claude Code, Cursor and Zed as daily tools

Governance and strategy

Tools, governance and workflows · integrating new technology into how a team works · design strategy tied to business and product goals · change management across functions · mentoring designers outside a reporting line

ONGOING

Independent Consultant

Oratio&Co

2016 – Present · Remote

Collaborative leadership coaching and product-strategy consulting for mission-driven organizations.

PROFILE

Head of Product Design at Bibel TV, where the design system across iOS, Android, web and connected TV is mine. DTCG tokens in four tiers, synced live to Figma and Android, so one commit reaches every platform. The people building with it are product managers and external engineers, which is why the component and view tiers exist: spacing, type size and radius change in the token API rather than in an agency ticket. Design-system governance at Ninox and component specifications at Datameer before that.

Enforced in the build

checks in CI refuse a token reference that does not resolve, or a color written straight into a component

Accessibility in code

WCAG contrast validated inside the color algorithm, and an EU Accessibility Act audit that covered the sites customers build

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web and connected TV) · Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- Standardization and flexibility, held apart by architecture — component and view tiers that alias downward and add no new values, so product teams get room on a shared foundation without the primitives moving.
- The external engineering agency backed it — it takes billable work away from them. The tiers are a step toward server-driven UI for the streaming app.
- Self-serve for product managers, engineers and AI assistants — Storybook as the shared surface, with the token vocabulary handed to the assistant as an enumerated list rather than recalled, so the compliant path is the fast one.
- Enforcement in the build — checks in CI reject a token reference that does not resolve, or a color written in by hand. Neither is a visual difference, so nothing else catches them.
- Color engine in production — themes built from content artwork, with WCAG contrast validated inside the algorithm.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) · Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- EU Accessibility Act compliance — we audited our own site and the sites customers build on the platform. Those are made by parish staff, so the standard had to hold without them.
- AI-generated alt text, shipped — across six countries, under GDPR plus church data-protection law.
- Booking module — the plan was a standalone add-on; I argued for building it into the platform and delivered it that way. 70% less coordination time, 90% acceptance.

Head of Product Design · Interim Head of Product

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) · Berlin, Germany

- Shared design-system governance — a working group of four designers and engineering, with a clear path for settling disagreements. Motion carried in the system as shared easing curves.
- Ran design and product at the same time — for four months, nine people across design, UX writing, product management and data science, on the senior leadership team. Hired two, promoted two.

Product & UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

Hypoport hub SE (shared services arm of listed Hypoport SE) · Berlin / Lübeck, Germany · Remote

- Turned a services business into a product catalog — with the executive team of a listed group, and ran the design-thinking training for leadership.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) · Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Defined how components behaved — what each one did, what it guaranteed and where it could be used, across the design system library.
- Led the design team across Germany and NYC for five years, setting the design bar across both sites.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

Senior Mentor · *CareerFoundry* · 2016 – 2026 · Remote · a decade reviewing and critiquing designers' work

Mentor · *Interaction Design Foundation* · 2020 – 2022 · Remote

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig, Germany · 200+ people

Earlier · *UX Manager, UX Designer, Web Developer* · 2009 – 2014 · Pennsylvania, USA